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AFP

■ President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan is received by Russian President Vladimir Putin at the Kremlin in Moscow yesterday.

Putin: UAE could host summit with Trump

RUSSIAN LEADER RECEIVES UAE PRESIDENT IN MOSCOW

MOSCOW

Russian President Vladimir Putin yesterday named the UAE as a potential location for an upcoming summit with US counterpart Donald Trump.

“We have many friends who are willing to help us organise such events. One of our friends is the President of the United Arab Emirates,” Putin said standing next to President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, adding “it (the UAE) would be one of the quite suitable places”.

Asked who initiated the possible talks with the American president, Putin said that didn’t matter and “both sides expressed an interest.”

Conditions not met

Putin, however, said that “conditions” for a potential meeting with Volodymyr Zelensky had not been met, hours after the Ukrainian leader repeated a call for direct talks..

“I have nothing against it in

We have many friends who are willing to help us organise such events. One of our friends is the President of the United Arab Emirates ... it [the UAE] would be one of the quite suitable places.”

Vladimir Putin
Russian President

general, it is possible, but certain conditions must be created for this. But unfortunately, we are still far from creating such conditions,” he said.

A Kremlin official earlier said a Trump-Putin meeting could happen as soon as next week. The announcement came on the eve of a White House deadline for Moscow to show progress in ending the three-year war in Ukraine.

The UAE has played a key mediating role this year, facilitating the exchange of

hundreds of prisoners of war between Russia and Ukraine – efforts that drew public thanks from both Putin and Zelensky.

Last month, Shaikh Khalid Bin Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Crown Prince of Abu Dhabi, met Putin in Minsk on behalf of the UAE President and attended the Supreme Eurasian Economic Council summit.

Arrival in Moscow

Earlier yesterday, the UAE President arrived in Moscow on an official visit to Russia. Upon entering Russian airspace, Shaikh Mohammad’s plane was welcomed and escorted by military aircraft. Shaikh Mohammad was accorded an official reception following his arrival at Vnukovo Airport, where the national anthems of the UAE and Russia were played. An honour guard was assembled for the UAE President, who greeted senior officials lined up in welcome.

— Agencies
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UAE rejects unfounded allegations by Sudan

‘They are entirely false, lack any evidentiary basis’

ABU DHABI

The Union Association for Human Rights (UAHR) has expressed its deep regret and dismay regarding the statement issued by the so-called “Port Sudan Authority” on August 4, 2025, which contained baseless allegations and unfounded claims against the UAE.

In a statement released yesterday, the UAHR affirmed that the content of this statement is a blatant attempt to mislead public opinion and distract attention from well-documented

and grave violations of international humanitarian law and international human rights law “including war crimes against civilians” as reported by the United Nations and the Independent UN Fact-Finding Mission on Sudan.

The UAE also rejected an announcement from Sudan’s armed forces saying they had destroyed an Emirati plane ferrying Colombian mercenaries into the country to back its paramilitary rivals.

“These unfounded allegations ... are entirely false, lack any evidentiary basis, and represent a continuation of (Sudan’s) ongoing campaign of disinformation and deflection,” a UAE official told AFP.

— Agencies

UAE ranked first globally in 10 labour market indicators

Nation’s labour market achieves top rankings in global competitiveness index

ABU DHABI

BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

In a new international milestone, the UAE has claimed the top global ranking in 10 key labour market and employment indicators, according to the 2025 edition of the World Competitiveness Yearbook, published by the IMD World Competitiveness Centre.

In addition to these first-place rankings, the UAE secured second place in four indicators, third in three, fourth in two, as well as fifth, sixth, and eighth in one indicator each.

These exceptional global results reaffirm the UAE’s standing as a premier destination for living, working, and investing, and underscore the country’s commitment to sustainable economic growth. This latest achievement further enhances the nation’s reputation as a global model for development and competitiveness.

Hub for skilled talent

Despite strong competition from advanced economies, the UAE maintained its position at the top of several long-standing indicators and recorded significant improvements across multiple other benchmarks.

The UAE achieved second place globally in:

- Proportion of foreign labour force
- Labour force participation rate

TOP RANK IN:

- Low labour disputes
- Low costs of terminating employment
- Workforce growth
- Availability of international experience
- Labour market competitiveness
- Working hours
- Employment rate
- Employment growth
- Availability of senior specialised managers
- Absence of bureaucracy

- Availability of skilled foreign labour
- Financial skills

Third place in:

- Availability of qualified engineers
- Unemployment expectations
- Availability of skilled labour

Fourth place in:

- Labour regulations
- Long-term unemployment rate

Additionally, the UAE ranked:

- 5th in labour unit costs for the overall economy
- 6th in youth unemployment
- 8th in low brain drain

The UAE has cemented its reputation as a hub for skilled talent and professional expertise across key economic sectors. This is driven by forward-thinking labour policies and the country’s ability to attract international talent with ease.

NATION

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